

There might be bigger issues in the report, though, to which you should pay close attention. Foundation work is expensive. Meth remediation is expensive, and mold remediation can be too. Electrical rewiring can run into the tens of thousands of dollars. Cast-iron pipes corrode from the inside out, so one day everything is fine, and the next morning there is raw sewage in your basement. But before we go there...

Stop. Take a breath. We're not trying to freak you out. If this is your first home purchase, you simply don't know what you don't know. That's why you're reading this book, after all—and that's exactly why we wrote it. We want you to buy a solid house, not a home that looks pretty but is on the verge of falling apart. If you're intentionally buying a house that needs work, we want you to understand the exact scope of that work.

In order to arm you with knowledge about each of these big-ticket repairs, we're going to have to scare you a little—but it comes from a place of love. Because the inspection report treats all problems equally, you need to know how to differentiate between a broken outlet and an entire electrical overhaul.

We talked about the Big Seven repairs (see, we knew that name would come in handy!) and what they might cost you. Let's talk a little bit more about what should be considered a deal breaker for a first-time home buyer.

DON'T EVEN THINK ABOUT IT

- **Don't touch meth.** Probably good life advice in general, but we're talking about meth remediation. When a property is used to make meth, it becomes contaminated. Not only is it expensive to get cleaned, it's an obvious health and safety hazard. Unless your day job is working for a meth remediation firm, walk away from any home that tests positive for meth.
- **Significant foundation problems.** The foundation is the support structure of the entire home, so you can only imagine what happens if there are issues with it. Yes, these issues can be fixed—but they are extremely expensive and definitely not DIY.
- **Underground oil tanks.** Yes, this is a thing. Before anybody knew any better, they would use these buried tanks as a source of heating.